ENGLISH GRAMMAR IN USE · UNITS 1–17 · MIXED REVIEW

RESPAWN

Back from the break. Back in the game.

Present simple and continuous · past simple and continuous · present perfect (simple and continuous) · for, since, how long · past perfect (simple and continuous) · have and have got — mixed together the way they are in real life: on campus, in the lab, at home and on Discord.

HOW THIS REVIEW WORKS

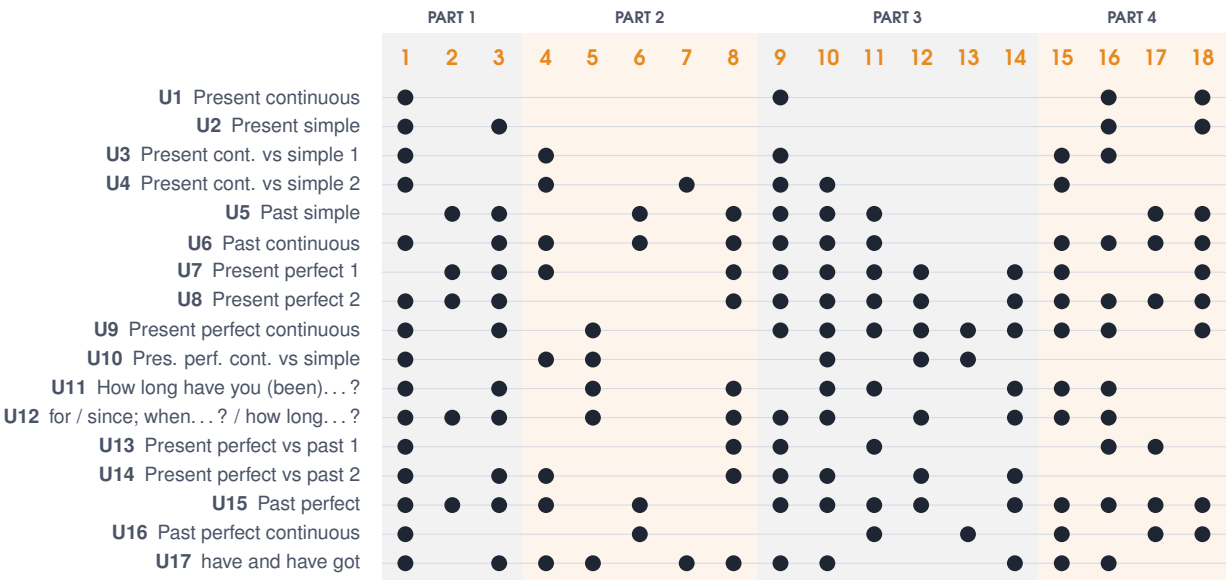
1. **Say it, then write it.** Before you write any answer, say the whole sentence out loud at normal speed. You're training your mouth, not just your pen.
2. **Rate your confidence** in Exercise 1. A mistake you were *sure* about is the most useful mistake you can make: once it's corrected, it tends to stick.
3. **Closed book.** No book, no key, no internet until you've finished a part.
4. **Tag your mistakes.** Every answer in the key has a unit tag (U7). On the last page, colour one square per mistake: your hottest rows are the units to revisit.
5. **Space it out.** Three sessions on different days beat one marathon: Parts 1–2 → Part 3 → Part 4 + review. Then repeat Part 4 a week later.

ICONS

Daily life · University · Engineering & lab · Discord & Overwatch · From your vocab vault

Write · Speak · Think / puzzle · Timed

WHAT EACH EXERCISE TRAINS (a dot = the unit is tested there — every unit comes back several times, mixed with the others)



PART 1

WARM-UP

Quick retrieval. First instinct, then confidence.

1 Snap decisions

U1 U2 U3 U4 U6 U8 U9 U10 U11 U12 U13 U14 U15 U16 U17

Choose the correct form. Go fast — about ten seconds per sentence. Then rate your confidence: ● sure ◐ 50/50 ○ guess. Circle one for each sentence.

1 Sorry, I can't talk right now — I [cook / 'm cooking] dinner. Can I call you back? ●◐○

2 I ['ve lost / lost] my student card last week, but someone handed it in at reception. ●◐○

3 [Have you got / Are you having] a spare HDMI cable? ●◐○

4 When I looked outside, the sun was shining, but the streets were wet. It [was raining / had been raining]. ●◐○

5 I [always cycle / 'm always cycling] to campus — it's faster than the bus. ●◐○

6 How long [are you / have you been] in Belgium? ●◐○

7 Who [has invented / invented] the transistor? ●◐○

8 We ['ve been sending / 've sent] over 300 messages in the group chat today, and nobody has started the report. ●◐○

9 Tom [is / is being] really rude today. He's normally so chill. ●◐○

10 This is the first time I [try / 've tried] waterzooi — it's amazing! ●◐○

11 I [played / was playing] ranked when my internet went down. ●◐○

12 It's been ages [since / for] we last played together. ●◐○

13 Steel [expands / is expanding] when it gets hot, so bridges need expansion joints. ●◐○

14 I didn't recognise Ruben at first — he [grew / had grown] a beard. ●◐○

15 Why are you out of breath? [Have you run / Have you been running]? ●◐○

16 It's 10:30. [Did you see / Have you seen] Marta this morning? ●◐○

17 I ['ve known / 've been knowing] Arne since our first week at uni. ●◐○

18 We [had / had got] a dog when I was a kid. ●◐○

19 Rents in Leuven [rise / are rising] so fast — mine went up again in September. ●◐○

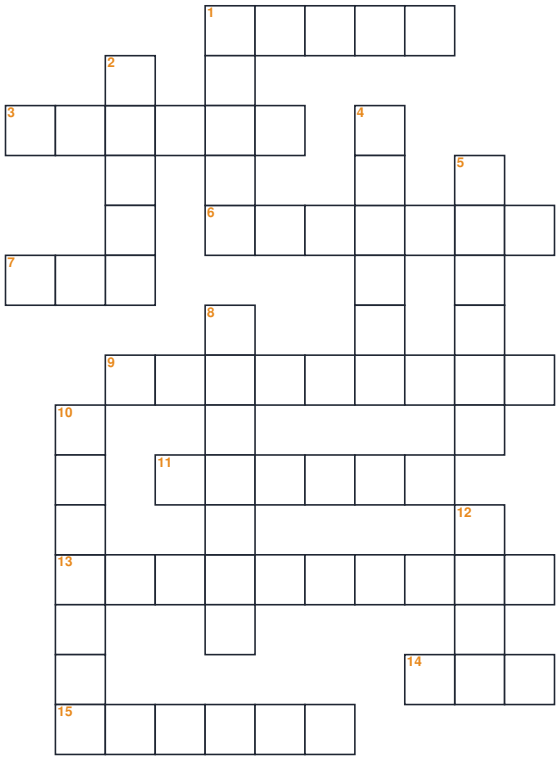
20 I ['ve been writing / 've written] the intro of our report for three days, and it's still not finished. ●◐○

Before you check: read all twenty sentences aloud with your answers, at normal speaking speed. Any sentence that "sounds wrong" in your mouth? Put a small **?** next to it.

2 Crossword: forms on the fly

U5 U7 U8 U12 U15

Each clue is a sentence. Complete it with the **past simple** or the **past participle** of the verb in brackets, then write the word in the grid. Say the full sentence aloud as you go.



ACROSS

1 Last night we _____ (spend) three hours looking for one missing semicolon.

3 My game has _____ (freeze) — I can't move!

6 I _____ (think) the exam was at ten, but it had started at nine!

7 We've _____ (win) five games in a row — don't jinx it!

9 I've _____ (forget) my password for the third time this week.

11 Someone has _____ (steal) my bike saddle. Welcome to Leuven!

13 I had never really _____ (understand) Fourier series until the TA drew them.

14 We _____ (meet) in the first-year chemistry lab.

15 Who _____ (teach) you to play Lúcio like that?

DOWN

1 I haven't _____ (sleep) properly since the exam period started.

2 I've only just _____ (wake) up — give me five minutes.

4 "Sorry, you've _____ (catch) me at a bad time. Can I call you back?"

5 Have you _____ (choose) your electives for next semester yet?

8 I've _____ (write) three lab reports this week — my wrist hurts.

10 Has anyone _____ (bring) snacks for the study session?

12 "Where's Jonas?" "He's _____ (go) to the shop. He'll be back in ten."

3 Questions in the wild

U2 U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U11 U12 U14 U15 U17

Put the words in order to make questions you could hear in your first weeks back. Then answer each one **out loud**, truthfully, in one breath (start within three seconds).

1 back / Leuven / long / in / you / have / been / how

2 Ardennes / been / ever / the / to / you / have

3 summer / up / to / since / been / you / the / what / have

4 gym / you / how / go / do / to / the / often

5 happened / were / doing / blackout / you / the / when / what

6 timetable / checked / yet / the / exam / have / you

7 bed / last / go / you / time / to / did / what / night

8 spare / you / a / pen / have / got

9 arrived / started / lecture / you / had / already / when / the

10 Dutch / learning / you / long / been / have / how

PART 2 AIM TRAINING

Precision shots: often both forms are grammatical — the meaning decides.

4 Same words, different story

U3 U4 U6 U7 U10 U14 U15 U17

Each pair is almost identical — but the grammar changes the story. Draw lines to connect each sentence (**a**/**b**) with the continuation or situation (**i**/**ii**) that fits it.

1
- **a** I've lived in Leuven for two years. •
- **b** I lived in Leuven for two years. •

- • **i** And honestly, I still love it here.
- • **ii** Then I moved to Antwerp for my internship.

2
- **a** When I got to the lab, the TA was leaving. •
- **b** When I got to the lab, the TA had left. •

- • **i** So I didn't see her at all.
- • **ii** So I managed to ask her one quick question at the door.

3
- **a** I've been fixing the 3D printer. •
- **b** I've fixed the 3D printer. •

- • **i** That's why my hands are covered in grease. It still doesn't work, though.
- • **ii** It works now — go and print your part.

4
- **a** Mila always borrows my calculator before exams. •
- **b** Mila is always borrowing my calculator. •

- • **i** Honestly, she should just buy her own.
- • **ii** It's become a kind of good-luck ritual, and I don't mind.

5	**a** What do you think of the new hero?	•	• **i** You look miles away.
	b What are you thinking about?	•	• **ii** Is she worth learning for ranked?
6	**a** Tom is selfish.	•	• **i** He never shares anything with anyone.
	b Tom is being selfish.	•	• **ii** He isn't usually like this — he must be stressed about the exam.
7	**a** When Leo called, I had dinner.	•	• **i** I was in the middle of eating, so I didn't pick up.
	b When Leo called, I was having dinner.	•	• **ii** We talked for a bit, and then I ate.
8	**a** Jonas has gone to Brazil.	•	• **i** He'll be back in September.
	b Jonas has been to Brazil.	•	• **ii** He showed me his photos of Rio yesterday.
9	**a** When the match ended, I logged off.	•	• **i** I missed the final fight — I'd rage-quit after the second round.
	b When the match ended, I had logged off.	•	• **ii** I stayed till the end, then went to bed.
10	**a** They're having a barbecue.	•	• **i** Want to join? I can smell it from here.
	b They have a barbecue.	•	• **ii** It's in the garden, but they never use it.
11	**a** I haven't seen Marta this morning.	•	• **i** Said at 4 p.m.
	b I didn't see Marta this morning.	•	• **ii** Said at 10 a.m.

5 One situation, two angles

U9 U10 U11 U12 U17

For each situation write two sentences: the first about the **activity and how long** (present perfect continuous, where possible), the second about the **result** — how much or how many (present perfect simple). Careful: in two situations the verb doesn't like continuous forms.

1 you · revise for the thermodynamics exam · since 9 a.m. | cover · four chapters

HOW LONG _____

RESULT _____

2 Wout · play ranked · all evening | lose · six games in a row

HOW LONG _____

RESULT _____

3 we · try to fix this bug · for two hours | find · three new bugs

HOW LONG _____

RESULT _____

4 my housemate · cook · since lunchtime | make · enough lasagne for ten people

HOW LONG _____

RESULT _____

5 I · have this laptop · since 2021 | it · crash · three times this week

HOW LONG _____

RESULT _____

6 I · learn Dutch · for two years | learn · about 2,000 words

HOW LONG _____

RESULT _____

7 Ines and I · know each other · since primary school | she · visit me in Leuven · twice

HOW LONG _____

RESULT _____

8 I · train for a half-marathon · since September | run · over 300 km

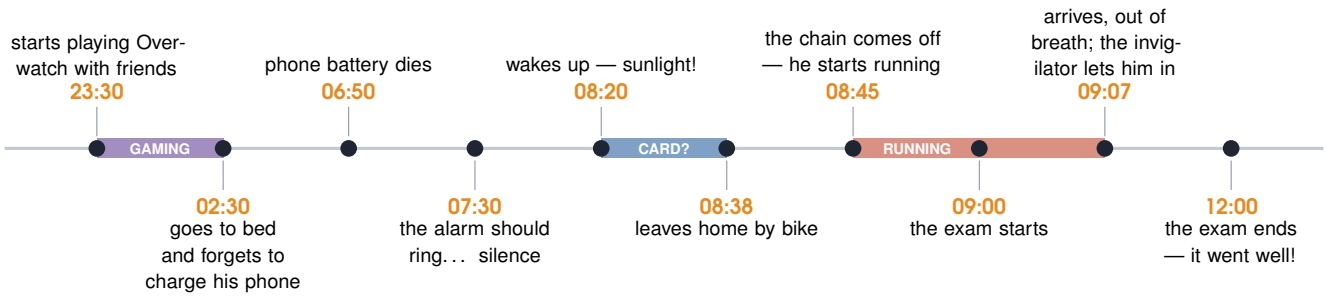
HOW LONG _____

RESULT _____

6 The Monday from hell

U5 U6 U15 U16

Look at Tiago's Monday. Answer the questions in full sentences. Each answer needs a different past form — think about *which moment* you are looking from.



1 Why didn't Tiago's alarm go off?

2 What had he been doing until 2:30 a.m.?

3 What was he doing at 8:30?

4 What happened while he was cycling to campus?

5 Had the exam started when he arrived?

6 Why was he out of breath when he walked in?

7 How long had the other students been writing when he walked in?

8 **Your turn.** Tell the whole story in four or five sentences, starting with: *When Tiago finally walked into the exam hall, . . .*

Exam-day words
invigilator (BrE; AmE *proctor*) — the person who watches students during an exam · **exam hall** · **student card** · **oversleep** (overslept) — sleep longer than you planned · **the alarm didn't go off** · **my phone died / the battery ran out** · **the chain came off** · **out of breath**

7 Continuous allowed?

U4 U17

Are the underlined verbs OK? Tick **OK** or **fix**, and write the correction. For the correct sentences marked ★, say *why* the continuous is possible there.

1 I'm thinking of switching to the Design option next year. ★ ☐ OK ☐ fix

2 Sorry, I'm not understanding the question. ☐ OK ☐ fix

3 Can you taste this? I think it's needing more salt. ☐ OK ☐ fix

4 You're looking really tired — are you OK? ☐ OK ☐ fix

5 We're having a great time at the cantus! ★ ☐ OK ☐ fix

6 My housemate is having a Tesla. ☐ OK ☐ fix

7 He's being so stubborn about the design — normally he listens. ★ ☐ OK ☐ fix

8 These headphones aren't belonging to me. ☐ OK ☐ fix

9 Are you seeing that Widow on the roof? ☐ OK ☐ fix _____

10 How are you feeling after the exam? ☐ OK ☐ fix _____

11 I'm usually feeling tired on Mondays. ☐ OK ☐ fix _____

12 What are you thinking of the new campus library? ☐ OK ☐ fix _____

8 Micro-dialogues

U5 U6 U7 U8 U11 U12 U13 U14 U17

Complete the mini-conversations with the correct form of the verbs. Then read each one aloud, playing both roles — the second speaker should sound like a real reaction, not a grammar exercise.

1 **A** Have you heard? Someone 1 _____ (*steal*) the projector from room 01.15!
B Seriously? When 2 _____ (*it / happen*)?
A Last night, apparently. The cleaners 3 _____ (*notice*) it at six this morning.

2 **A** Is Jonas around? I need the multimeter.
B He 4 _____ (*go*) to the workshop. He'll be back in ten minutes.

3 **A** 5 _____ (*you / ever / try*) a waffle from one of those food trucks?
B Yes, I 6 _____ (*have*) one at the Christmas market last year. It 7 _____ (*be*) amazing.

4 **A** You look exhausted.
B I am. I 8 _____ (*not / sleep*) properly since the exam period 9 _____ (*start*).

5 **A** How long 10 _____ (*you / know*) Sofia?
B Since first year. We 11 _____ (*meet*) in the chemistry lab — she 12 _____ (*spill*) coffee all over my notes.

6 **A** Ow! I 13 _____ (*cut*) my finger.
B Let me see. How 14 _____ (*you / do*) that?
A I 15 _____ (*strip*) a wire with a knife and it 16 _____ (*slip*).

7 **A** 17 _____ (*you / see*) the match last night?
B No, I 18 _____ (*not / have*) time — I 19 _____ (*work*) on my report until midnight.

8 **A** It's ages since we last 20 _____ (*go*) out together.
B I know! I 21 _____ (*not / be*) to a bar since June.

9 **A** That's the third time the coffee machine 22 _____ (*break*) down this week!
B Classic. I 23 _____ (*bring*) my own coffee today, just in case.

PART 3

SCRIMS

Practice matches: real situations, mixed tenses, no warnings.

9 Voice chat: Thursday, 22:47

U1 U3 U4 U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U12 U13 U14 U15 U17

You're in a Discord call with your team. Complete the transcript with the correct form of the verbs in brackets. Then do the vocabulary task below.

ow-comp · Voice connected · 5 in call

PRE-GAME

Lotte
Can everyone hear me? I 1 _____ (*just / change*) my mic settings.

You
Yeah, loud and clear. Wout, you 2 _____ (*break up*) a bit.

Wout
Sorry, my ping 3 _____ (*spike*) all evening. My housemate 4 _____ (*download*) some massive game update.

Kai
Classic. So, who 5 _____ (*play*) tank?

Lotte
Me. I 6 _____ (*not / play*) Sigma since last season, so let's go Rein.

Mira
Rein works. We 7 _____ (*lose*) three games in a row on Sigma yesterday anyway.

MID-MATCH

You
Their Genji 8 _____ (*flank*) left! Kai, 9 _____ (*you / see*) him?

Kai
Got him — but my sleep dart's on cooldown.

Wout
Careful, their Zarya 10 _____ (*have*) grav. They 11 _____ (*farm*) ult charge off Lotte's shield for ages.

Lotte
OK, group up on me. Nobody goes in alone.

Mira
Sorry, I'm dead. Their Widow 12 _____ (*shoot*) me from that window again. It's the third time she 13 _____ (*kill*) me from there!

You
She 14 _____ (*always / do*) that. Someone needs to dive her.

AFTER THE FIGHT

Kai
What happened in that last fight?

L Lotte
I 15 _____ (*hold*) my shield on the point when their D.Va 16 _____ (*bomb*) us.

W Wout
Yeah, and by the time I 17 _____ (*get*) back from spawn, they 18 _____ (*already / take*) the point.

M Mira
We 19 _____ (*fight*) on this point for five minutes, and we 20 _____ (*still / not / win*) a single team fight.

Y You
OK, I 21 _____ (*think*) we need to play around our ults. Kai, 22 _____ (*you / have*) yours?

K Kai
Almost — 85%.

POST-GAME

L Lotte
GG, everyone! Anyone up for a few rounds of Stadium?

Y You
Can't, sorry — I 23 _____ (*have*) a lab report due on Friday, and I 24 _____ (*not / even / start*) it yet.

Comms phrasebook — match the phrases (1–8) from the call to their meanings (a–h)

1 loud and clear
2 you're breaking up
3 my ping is spiking
4 on cooldown
5 group up
6 flank
7 dive (someone)
8 farm ult charge

a jump onto a target in the enemy's backline
b come together before you fight
c I can hear you perfectly
d build up your ultimate by hitting easy targets
e my connection delay keeps jumping up
f used recently, not ready yet
g your voice keeps cutting out
h attack from the side or from behind

Also useful on Discord: You're muted! · Can you hear me now? · You've got an echo. · I'm lagging. · Hop in the call. · brb / AFK · Run it back? (= play again with the same team) · GG / GGWP

Say it: record a 60-second post-match debrief on your phone. What happened in your last match (past simple / continuous)? What had gone wrong before the final fight (past perfect)? What have you been doing to improve lately (present perfect continuous)?

10 Group chat: find the ten mistakes

U4 U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U10 U11 U12 U14 U15 U17

Your Engineering Experience team is building a line-following robot. **Ten** messages contain one tense mistake each; **four** are correct. Find the mistakes and write the corrections in the table. (🔑 = an expression from your vocabulary vault.)

EE Robot · Team 7 Lien, Daan, Sem, You

Lien 09:12
Morning! Quick update: I've finished the wiring diagram yesterday. It's on the drive. 1

Daan 09:15
Nice! I'm working on the PID code since Monday and the robot still doesn't follow the line properly. 2

3 **You** 09:16
Have you tried lowering the gain? It was oscillating like crazy when I tested it on Friday.

Daan 09:18
Yes, I've already tried that. Honestly, I can't wrap my head around 🔑 PID controllers. 4

Sem 09:20
I'm knowing a guy in the year above who did the same project. I'll ask him. 5

Lien 09:24
Good idea. Also, the left sensor doesn't work since we dropped it on Thursday. 6

7 **You** 09:25
Can you send me the CAD files? I haven't got access to the drive yet.

Sem 09:31
Done. Btw, when have you sent the draft to Prof. Claes? 8

9 **You** 09:32
Last night. And sorry I missed your call — I slept.

Daan 09:40
No worries. It's the first time I use an oscilloscope, so I'm slow in the lab. 10

Lien 09:41
Same ☺ Also, we have got a meeting with our supervisor last Tuesday — she said the intro is too long. 11

Sem 09:43
Lien has been writing six pages of the intro, so we can definitely cut some. 12

13 **You** 09:47
I've been chipping away at 🔑 the results section all week. Almost done!

Daan 09:52
Yesterday, by the time I got to the lab, everyone left, so I tested the robot alone. 14

MSG	WRONG	CORRECT

11 The case of the flooded kot

U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U11 U13 U15 U16

Saturday, 9:15 a.m. Water has been coming under the bathroom door of your student house, and the hallway carpet is soaked. Someone left the sink tap running — and the drain has been blocked for weeks. Your landlord, Mr Peeters, has just arrived.

A Messages Complete with the correct form of the verbs.

Mr Peeters I 1 _____ (*just / arrive*). How long 2 _____ (*the water / come*) under the door?

You We don't know exactly — Dries found it just before nine. But the drain 3 _____ (*be*) blocked for weeks! We 4 _____ (*tell*) you three times since September.

Mr Peeters OK, OK. I 5 _____ (*call*) a plumber. Now — who left the tap running?

B Statements Your four housemates were at home that morning. Read carefully — the tenses tell you the order of events.

Ana "I got up at about half past seven. When I came out of my room, Bram was going into the bathroom, so I brushed my teeth in the kitchen and left for the gym."

Bram "I had a quick shower and then I shaved. When I came out of the bathroom, Chloé had already gone downstairs. Then I left for football training. I'm sure I turned the tap off."

Chloé "I'd had a shower the night before, so I went straight down for breakfast. When I went down, Dries was still sleeping — I could hear him snoring through the wall. I didn't go back upstairs: I left for the lab at about half past eight."

Dries "I'd been playing Overwatch until four in the morning, so I slept until almost nine. When I got up, everyone had already left, and water was coming under the bathroom door."

a Who was in the bathroom when Ana came out of her room?

b Did Chloé use the bathroom that morning?

c Where was Chloé when Bram came out of the bathroom?

d What was Dries doing when Chloé went downstairs?

e Who was the last person to use the sink — and who left the tap running?

f Explain why it *wasn't* Chloé or Dries. Write two sentences, each with a past perfect.

House & flat words
kot (Leuven student slang) — student room or house · **landlord** (*kotbaas* in Leuven) · **housemate** / **flatmate** · **tap** (AmE *faucet*) · **sink** · **the drain is blocked** (AmE *clogged*) · **soaked** — completely wet · **plumber** · **mop up** the water · **overflow**

12 Email to your professor

U7 U8 U9 U10 U12 U14 U15

Write **one word** in each gap. Contractions (*haven't*, *'ve*) count as one word. No verb hints this time — use the meaning.

Subject: Lab Report 3 — request for a short extension

Dear Professor Claes,

I hope you are well. I am writing about Lab Report 3, which is due this Friday.

Unfortunately, I 1 _____ been ill 2 _____ last Thursday, and I have only 3 _____ started to feel better. I went to the doctor two days 4 _____, and I have attached the medical certificate to this email.

Before I got sick, my lab partner and I 5 _____ already done all the measurements, so the data is ready. However, I 6 _____ written the discussion section 7 _____.

Our group 8 _____ been working on this report 9 _____ almost three weeks, and this is the first time I have 10 _____ asked for an extension. 11 _____ you had a chance to look at the draft we sent you? We 12 _____ received any feedback so far.

Would it be possible to submit the report next Monday instead?

Thank you very much for your understanding.

Kind regards,
Tiago Ferreira (r0923415)

Polite email toolkit
I'm writing about / to ask… · **a short extension** · **due** (= must be handed in) · **submit / hand in** · **a medical certificate** · **a draft** · **Have you had a chance to…?** (polite reminder) · **Would it be possible to…?** · **Thank you for your understanding.**

13 Sherlock mode

U9 U10 U16

Look at the evidence. What *has been happening*? Use the present perfect continuous — unless the action is clearly finished and you're thinking of the result (then use the present perfect simple). The two PAST cards happened yesterday: use *had been -ing*.

1
Your housemate's hands are black with grease, and his bike is upside down in the hallway.

2
Kai's voice is completely hoarse on Discord.

3
The lab smells of burnt plastic, and the soldering iron is still hot.

4
There are six empty energy-drink cans on your desk, and the sun is coming up.

5
The packet of stroopwafels you bought yesterday is completely empty.

6
Your flatmate walks in soaking wet, holding a broken umbrella.

7
Wout's account jumped from Gold to Platinum in one weekend.

8 PAST
When you got home yesterday, Lotte was sweaty and her yoga mat was on the floor.

9 PAST
When the professor came back into the lab, two students were giggling and the whiteboard was full of drawings of him.

Words: *hoarse* — rough-voiced from shouting · *grind* (gaming) — play a lot, again and again, to progress · *soldering iron* · *stroopwafel* — the famous Dutch caramel waffle

14 Same meaning, new shape

U7 U8 U9 U11 U12 U14 U15 U17

Complete the second sentence so that it means the same as the first. Use the word on the right — don't change it — and two to six words in total.

1 I started studying in Leuven three years ago. **BEEN**

I _____ in Leuven for three years.

2 The last time I visited my grandparents was at Christmas. **SINCE**

I _____ Christmas.

3 I've never eaten such good fries. **BEST**

These are _____ I've ever eaten.

4 This is my first time using an oscilloscope. **USED**

It's the first time _____ an oscilloscope.

5 Arne and I became friends during our first week. **KNOWN**

I _____ since our first week.

6 It's ages since I last went to the cinema. **FOR**

I _____ ages.

7 When did you start learning Dutch? **HOW**

_____ learning Dutch?

8 Lena went to the library and she's still there. **GONE**

Lena _____ the library.

9 The lecture started before I arrived. **ALREADY**

When I arrived, the lecture _____.

10 Do you have a spare charger? **GOT**

_____ a spare charger?

11 I lived in São Paulo from 2015 to 2022. **FOR**

I _____ seven years.

12 He started playing an hour ago, and he's still playing. **FOR**

He _____ an hour.

PART 4
COMMS

Say it out loud. Fluency is a skill, and it gets faster with reps.

15 The 3-second rule

U3 U4 U6 U7 U8 U9 U11 U12 U15 U16 U17

These are the sentences where Portuguese most often pulls you into the wrong tense. Read each one, then **say it in English within three seconds** — no word-by-word translating. Only then write it. Repeat the ones where you hesitated until they come out automatically.

1 *Moro em Leuven há três anos.* _____

2 *Faz séculos que eu não jogo com vocês!* _____

3 *Acabei de acordar, me dá cinco minutos.* _____

4 *Você já foi a Bruges?* _____

5 *Desde quando você joga de suporte?* _____

6 *Quando eu cheguei, a aula já tinha começado.* _____

7 *Eu estava jogando quando a internet caiu.* _____

8 *É a primeira vez que eu como waterzooi.* _____

9 *Ele vive deixando a louça na pia.* _____

10 *Tô com dor de cabeça.* _____

11 *Eu conheço ela desde o primeiro ano.* _____

12 *A gente tava esperando fazia vinte minutos quando o ônibus finalmente chegou.* _____

13 *O que você tá achando do curso?* _____

14 *Tá chovendo desde ontem.* _____

16 Rapid fire

U1 U2 U3 U6 U8 U9 U11 U12 U13 U15 U17

Answer each question **out loud** in two or three sentences. Start within five seconds and keep going for about twenty. Your first verb should be in the tense on the right. Record yourself if you can, listen once, and tick the box if you kept the tense.

1	What are you working on at uni at the moment?	present continuous ☐
2	What do you usually do on a Thursday night?	present simple ☐
3	What have you been doing to get your English back on track since you came back?	present perfect continuous ☐
4	Have you ever pulled an all-nighter? What happened?	present perfect → past simple ☐
5	What were you doing this time last year?	past continuous ☐
6	What's the best match you've ever played?	present perfect + past simple ☐
7	How long have you known your oldest friend? How did you meet?	present perfect + past simple ☐
8	What had you never done before you moved to Belgium?	past perfect ☐
9	What's something a housemate or teammate is always doing that drives you crazy?	always + continuous ☐
10	What have you got in your backpack right now?	have got ☐

17 One story, three speeds

U5 U6 U8 U13 U15 U16

Pick one story and tell it **three times**: in **4** minutes, then **3**, then **2**. Same story, same details — just faster. Tell it to a friend, or record it on your phone. This is the classic *4/3/2* fluency technique: from round to round, speakers usually get faster, hesitate less and make fewer mistakes in the parts they repeat.

A The worst match you've ever played

B Your first week back in Belgium

C A lab session that went completely wrong

Plan it in notes (keywords only — no full sentences):

1 Set the scene past continuous
It was. . . , I was . . . -ing, everybody was. . .

2 Before it all happened past perfect (+ cont.)
I'd never. . . , I'd been . . . -ing for. . .

3 What happened past simple, in order
Then. . . , suddenly. . . , when. . . , so. . .

4 Since then present perfect
Since then I've. . . , I've never. . . again.

Checklist (after round 3)
☐ two past continuous ☐ two past perfect (one continuous)
☐ three or more past simple ☐ one present perfect
☐ "It was the first time I'd. . . "

Timer
Round 1 (4 min): _____
Round 2 (3 min): _____
Round 3 (2 min): _____
Write how it felt: smoother? fewer pauses?

Vault bonus: slip two of these into your story — *work your tail off · a blessing in disguise · worn out · buckle down · pay off · hang tight*.

18 Shadow & rebuild

U1 U2 U5 U6 U7 U8 U9 U15 U16

1 Read the text aloud twice. Lean on the contractions (*I've, I'd, isn't*) — they're a big part of what makes speech sound fluent. **2** Cover the text and rebuild it out loud from the keywords on the right. **3** Change at least three details so the story is true for *you*, and tell it again without looking — record this version and listen to it once.

I've been back in Belgium for a couple of months now, and I've noticed something strange. I understand everything, but when I'm speaking, the words sometimes come out in the wrong order. Before I went to Brazil, I'd been using English every single day, so I'd never really thought about it. Then I spent months speaking almost only Portuguese. When I got back, I was ordering a coffee on campus and I completely froze — I'd forgotten how to say *oat milk*. Since then, I've been dusting off my English one habit at a time: I've been reading out loud every morning, I've started a voice diary, and I've joined more Discord calls with people from my course. It's working. This week I've already had two long conversations without freezing once. My English isn't broken. It's just been on cooldown.

Keywords

back · couple of months · noticed
understand — but speaking — wrong order
before Brazil — 'd been using — every day
'd never thought
spent months — only Portuguese
got back — ordering coffee — froze
'd forgotten — oat milk
since then — dusting off — one habit
reading out loud · voice diary · Discord calls
working — this week — already — two conversations
not broken — cooldown

AFTER THE GAME

POST-MATCH REVIEW

Check your answers with the key. For every mistake, colour one square in the row of the unit tag next to that answer (some answers have two tags — colour both). **Two or more squares** in a row: re-read that unit and redo its exercises in the book. **Zero or one**: you're good — move on.

U1	Present continuous	
U2	Present simple	
U3	Present cont. vs simple 1	
U4	Present cont. vs simple 2	
U5	Past simple	
U6	Past continuous	
U7	Present perfect 1	
U8	Present perfect 2	
U9	Present perfect continuous	
U10	Pres. perf. cont. vs simple	
U11	How long have you (been)...?	
U12	for / since; when...? / how long...?	
U13	Present perfect vs past 1	
U14	Present perfect vs past 2	
U15	Past perfect	
U16	Past perfect continuous	
U17	have and have got	

MY TOP 5 MISTAKES (start with the ones you were *sure* about)

	I SAID...	BUT IT'S... (AND WHY)
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		

Next match: repeat Part 4 (Comms) in about a week — spaced repetition is what turns "I know this" into "I just say it". Then carry on with Unit 18 (*used to*).